



The Monteverde Cloud Forest

One of the world's most biodiverse and protected habitats, where sea, moisture, and mountains create a rain forest constantly shrouded in clouds



Characterized by foglike clouds and humidity levels of close to 100 percent throughout the year, cloud forests make up just 1 percent of the world's woodlands. Costa Rica's Monteverde Cloud Forest, encompassing 40 square miles (105 square km), is nonetheless one of the most biodiverse habitats on Earth.

A safe haven

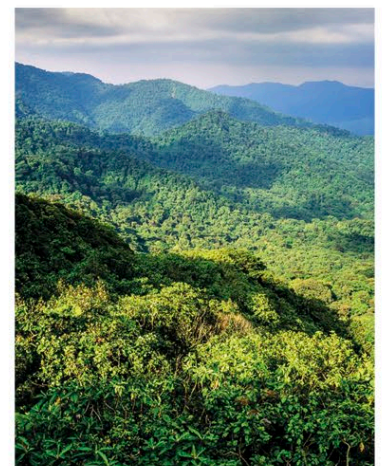
The highly protected Monteverde Cloud Forest Reserve is located around 4,720 ft (1,440 m) above sea level in the Cordillera de Tilarán, part of a larger mountain chain running along the center of Costa Rica.



Rainfall is extensive, with an average of 102 in (2,590 mm), while temperatures range between 57°F and 73°F (14°C and 23°C). Almost constant cloud covers the eastern forest, formed by warm Atlantic air ascending the mountains. The result is an astonishingly rich habitat containing more than 3,000 species of plants, as well as thousands of insect, 400 bird, and around 100 mammal species.

◀ SURVIVAL TACTIC

Algae-covered fur helps the brown-throated three-toed sloth blend in with its lush forest surroundings—vital for such a slow-moving mammal.



△ ONE FOREST, MANY TREES

At least 755 tree species grow in the Monteverde reserve. They are taller on the cloud-covered eastern slope and shorter on the drier western side.

Costa Rica is home to 4 percent of Earth's plant and animal species